JUSTIN THOMAS

Construction Project Manager — Utility-Scale Solar & Battery Energy Storage (BESS)

+91 94466 74610 | justinthomas1992@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/justinthomass | Available for remote role with 50–60% job-site travel

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Construction Project Manager with 11+ years in utility-scale solar and battery energy storage (BESS) construction — ~1 GWh of BESS and ~3.9 GW of solar — delivered from the EPC contractor, owner, developer and agency sides. Directs day-to-day project resources (staff, equipment, subcontractors and materials) against the Project Execution Plan; controls scope, schedule, cost, quality, risk, change and contract documents from mobilization through commissioning, handover and contract closeout. Champions safety, environmental and regulatory compliance with a Zero Injury mindset, builds a strong quality management culture, and coaches and mentors project teams. Ready to own Prevailing Wage & Apprenticeship (PWA) compliance execution in partnership with the PWA team on renewables projects supporting grid resilience and decarbonization.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Utility-Scale Solar & BESS Construction Management
- Project Execution Plan (PEP) & Resource Integration
- Schedule, Cost & Forecast Control
- Scope, Integration & Stakeholder Management
- Contract Documents, Change & Risk Management
- Subcontractor & Procurement Management (through Contract Closeout)
- Safety, Environmental & Regulatory Compliance (Zero Injury)
- Quality Management (ISO 9001:2015, QA/QC, NCR / RCA / CAPA)
- Coaching, Mentoring & Workforce Development
- Blueprint, Specification & Contract Interpretation
- Progress Reporting & Executive Presentations
- Testing, Commissioning & Handover

Software: Microsoft Office (Excel, Word, PowerPoint, Outlook), MS Project, AutoCAD, construction scheduling and document-control software, DPR / MIS reporting

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Manager – Electrical Projects (EPC Contractor) | Amara Raja Infra Pvt. Ltd. **Aug 2025 – Present**

125 MW / 500 MWh standalone LFP BESS, Kerala, India — Owner's Engineer: Tata Consulting Engineers

- Direct and oversee day-to-day construction resources — site staff, equipment, subcontractors and materials — integrating activities and deliverables with the Project Execution Plan on one of India's largest BESS projects under construction.
- Control construction schedule and progress across containerized LFP battery systems, PCS, MV/HV balance of plant and the 145 kV grid interconnection; document and communicate progress, performance and issues to the client, Owner's Engineer and senior management.
- Manage subcontractor and OEM procurement interface (battery containers, PCS, transformers, MV switchgear, power cables, EMS/SCADA, UPS) — submittals, drawing approvals, pre-dispatch inspection, site acceptance and defect closure.
- Manage contract documents and technical risk through a 278-entry RFI register tracked to closure, resolving design and field issues before they impact schedule or cost.
- Drive quality management and compliance — NCR management, root cause analysis, CAPA and inspection checklists — while enforcing HSE and permit-to-work systems to keep the site audit-ready.

- Coach and mentor site engineers and technicians through QA/QC procedures, checklists and on-site training to build team capability.

Owner's Engineer — Quality & Construction Oversight | TQ Cert Services Pvt. Ltd. (Tata Projects Ltd.) **Aug 2023 – Aug 2025**
500 MW BESS + solar hybrid, Khavda, Gujarat | 1,034 MW utility-scale solar, Jaisalmer, Rajasthan

- Represented the owner on two utility-scale renewables programmes, monitoring EPC contractor and subcontractor performance against scope, schedule, quality and safety commitments.
- Reviewed and approved contractor Quality Assurance Plans, Inspection & Test Plans, method statements and field quality procedures; enforced hold and witness points for evidence-based stage clearance.
- Evaluated deviation, concession and change requests on technical and contractual merit; reviewed design drawings and blueprints against specifications and standards.
- Performed factory acceptance testing and pre-dispatch inspection of modules, inverters, transformers, switchgear and battery systems — protecting procurement quality before materials reached site.
- Issued, tracked and closed NCRs and led quality audits, reporting findings and risks to owner stakeholders and top management.

Project Lead — Construction Execution (Developer / Owner) | Tata Power Renewable Energy Ltd. **Aug 2022 – Aug 2023**
450 MWp / 335 MWac solar, Bikaner, Rajasthan | 300 MW solar, Dholera, Gujarat

- Led construction execution across ~750 MW of utility-scale solar in two states, managing EPC contractors and subcontractors against schedule, quality and safety commitments.
- Integrated engineering, procurement, contracts, HSE and O&M functions to resolve interface issues and keep multi-package construction sites in sequence.
- Governed progress through site reviews, milestone verification and punch-list closure, driving projects to commissioning and commercial operation readiness.
- Prepared DPR / MIS progress reports and presented schedule status, risks and issues to stakeholders and management.

Project Engineer — Implementation | Solar Energy Corporation of India (SECI) **Oct 2020 – Aug 2022**
2,050 MW Pavagada Solar Park, Karnataka | 1.4 MWh island BESS, Lakshadweep

- Monitored developer and contractor delivery against milestones on the 2,050 MW Pavagada Solar Park, one of the world's largest solar parks.
- Delivered a 1.4 MWh island BESS installation, planning materials, equipment and logistics under remote, constrained site conditions.
- Applied tendering, contract and government-regulation knowledge to stakeholder management across developers, contractors and utilities.

Electrical Engineer — Construction Execution & O&M | KC Kopar Energy Solutions **Jun 2015 – Oct 2020**
25.4 MW solar, Cochin International Airport — world's first fully solar-powered airport

- Executed installation, testing and commissioning of 25.4 MW ground-mount, rooftop and canopy solar (modules, inverters, LT/HT switchgear, transformers, evacuation) within a live, security-controlled site.
- Coordinated crews, equipment and materials with airport operations to maintain jobsite safety and uninterrupted service.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATION

- B.Tech — Electrical & Electronics Engineering, SCMS School of Engineering & Technology, Cochin (2011 – 2015)
- Certified Lean Six Sigma Green Belt (CLSSGB)